

I said, "You tell him, he's absolutely wrong. Number one, I didn't tell him that was a biblical principle. I said it was what *we* did. Second, he can't drop that on you during spring break."

You must start such a plan at least 10 years before the first child enters college. You can't just decide to implement it on an impulse. As Paul said, "Fathers, do not provoke your children to anger; but bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord" (Ephesians 6:4).

Try to make your children a part of the planning process in your home, not the object of it. Share your budget with your children, just the same way they must share theirs with you.

22 TRAINING CHILDREN AGES 17-20

Some of you reading this book probably don't have teenagers yet, much less young adults. In fact, some of you probably fit into this age group yourselves. That's alright, we have all been 17-20 at one time or another, and all of our children will be. This is a crucial age, because these are the transition years to adulthood.

By this time the basics of personal finances *must* be understood and applied or the mistakes of past generations will be repeated. Here I would like to discuss the essentials that children should be taught while still under their parents' authority.

(1) *Work/vocation*. The essential step is to determine the personality, skills, and gifts that God has given to each of your children. In our generation, it is not abnormal for young men and women to graduate from college and have no idea what they want to do vocationally. All too often they take any job that is available, only to find out later that they dislike the career field. Usually it's because personality and career field are mismatched.

Marsha was an example of this mismatch between personality and vocation. She had studied accounting in college and graduated with good grades. She took a job with an auditing company and found that she dreaded the daily routine. The